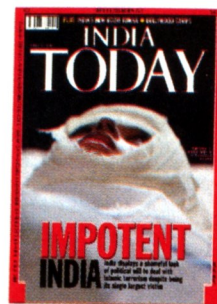


SHAILESH RAVAL



"Impotent India",
August 11, 2008

"Every act of brutality gives rise to yet another gruesome incident. First Jaipur, then Bangalore followed by Ahmedabad on terror target. When will this all end?"

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, on e-mail

Fear Factor

Let the security cover of all politicians be withdrawn and they be asked to live like common men ("The Nation That Failed", August 11). Their impotency and political will are bound to be revived.

VIJAY DANDIWALA, on e-mail

The cover story is a shrill wake-up call for the powers that be to get their act together and tackle the appallingly escalating terrorism literally on a war-footing. One hopes that your very valuable but feasible suggestions to stem the scourge do not fall on deaf ears yet again.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

INDIA TODAY deserves kudos for being bold enough to defy political authority and call a spade a spade. If it is able to stir a moribund establishment into taking decisive action before

another strike, the story would have achieved its objective.

U. NARAYANA DAS, Hyderabad

Votebank politics and minority appeasement have prevented the ruling UPA Government to pass stronger Acts to combat terror. To cap it all, we have a home minister—a well-dressed "white horse" who cannot think straight even on matters as sensitive as terrorism.

K.M.G. VIVEKANANDAM,
Madurai

Whether we accept it or not, terrorism has come here to stay. And it is too simplistic to think that a strict anti-terror law could minimise terror attacks. To combat such crises, the political parties should stand united rather than play blame game.

D.B.N. MURTHY, Bangalore

Being a Muslim, I strongly condemn any form of

terrorism. However, I strongly take objection to the usage of the phrase "Islamic terrorism" on the magazine's cover. Terrorists do not have a religion. One doesn't expect a reputed magazine like INDIA TODAY to be so irresponsible.

JAWAID AHSAN, Bangalore

As things stand today, India is least equipped to take on the diabolical designs of Islamic terrorism. The legal provisions we have today are inadequate and our security system is antediluvian. One wonders that if democratic countries can reconcile with draconian laws, which have worked as a deterrent to terrorism, why can't India too do the same?

P. PRASAND THAMPY, Thiruvella

When I picked up the magazine, the cover page headline "Impotent India" brazenly looked in my face in mock sarcasm as if saying "you too are one of

them". I am sure this must have hit many others too. Sadly, there is much truth to it. The editorial by Aroon Purie is indeed thought provoking. In fact, it has touched a raw nerve. India, at 61, turned impotent much before maturing and growing old. It has never experienced the joy of youth. The credit or rather the discredit goes to the political lords, who have ruthlessly turned India's tolerance into timidity. I hope the editorial awakens patriotism in every Indian to take up cudgels for India.

RANJANA GAUHAR, on e-mail

There is a well-established network of people who hate India so much that they assist militants in the dastardly acts. This has made this nation vulnerable to terrorist attacks.

VITULL K. GUPTA, on e-mail

The magazine deserves a